

Lab 02 — Your First Live Artefact

Topic 01 · Claude Cowork Fundamentals

Meridian Capital Partners Pte Ltd — all data in this lab is synthetic and for training only.

Goal

Now you have seen Cowork do a real piece of work, meet the other thing it makes: a Live Artefact. You build a small tool rather than ask a question, so you can see how an artefact differs from a chat answer — it persists, it is interactive, it pulls fresh data every time you open it, and you can save and download it.

You'll build

A saved, downloaded Live Artefact — an FX converter on live rates.

Tools: Claude desktop app, Claude Cowork, Live Artefacts

The prompt

Copy this into Claude (it is also in PROMPT.md):

PROMPT — copy into Claude

Build me a Live Artefact: a currency converter for Meridian Capital Partners that uses the LATEST exchange rates, not fixed ones.

Requirements:

- Convert between SGD, USD, EUR and GBP.
- Fetch current rates from a free, no-key exchange rate API each time the artefact is opened, and refresh them when I click a Refresh button.
- One amount box, a from-currency and a to-currency selector, and a large result.
- Under the result show the rate used and the time the rates were last fetched.
- If the rate lookup fails, say so plainly and show the last rate you had rather than a wrong number.
- Clean, professional finance styling. Label it "Meridian Capital Partners".

Make it interactive so I can change the amount and see the result update.

Note: Because the rates are live, your figures will differ from the screenshots — that is the point of a Live Artefact.

Steps

1. Start a new Cowork session — this lab needs no files.

Lab 1 gave Claude a folder to work in; here you are asking it to build something from nothing.

2. Paste the lab prompt into the composer and send it.

Claude writes the code and renders the converter in the preview pane beside the chat.

3. Try the converter: change the amount and switch the currencies.

This is what makes it an artefact rather than an answer — you can interact with it.

4. Check the live rate against a search for "1 USD to SGD".

The artefact fetched this rate seconds ago, so it should match. A fixed rate in a spreadsheet would already be out of date.

5. Click Refresh, and note the 'last fetched' time updates.

This is the 'Live' in Live Artefact — reopening or refreshing pulls current data rather than replaying a snapshot.

6. Ask for one refinement in plain English, for example: Add a thousands separator to the result.

Refining by conversation is the normal way to work — you never edit the code yourself.

7. Save the artefact so it appears in your sidebar.

A saved artefact persists as a reusable tool; an unsaved one scrolls away with the chat.

8. Download a copy of the artefact to your lab folder.

Downloading gives you a file you can keep, attach or hand to someone without Claude.

Check your work

Converting S\$10,000 to USD gives a figure that matches a live search for the SGD/USD rate, and the artefact shows when the rates were last fetched. Clicking Refresh updates that time. The artefact appears in your sidebar after saving, still works when you reopen it, and a downloaded copy is in your lab folder.

Further viewing

- CLAUDE COWORK FULL COURSE 3 HOURS For Beginners (2026)

Optional background, not needed to complete the lab.

Before you move on

Use only the supplied mock data and your own test accounts. Never put real client, personal or confidential data into a training exercise, and send lab emails to yourself rather than to a real recipient.